

CTF Write-up: Travellers – Shopping Centre

Category: OSINT • Points: 495

Challenge Overview

This challenge focused on identifying a location from a photograph linked to a suspect associated with the hacktivist group “**Travellers.**”

Objective: Determine the name of the building located directly behind the photographer.

- **Suspect Handle:** BelkaAndStrelka
- **Goal:** Identify the building behind the photographer
- **Flag Format:** SK-CERT{Building_Name}

Phase 1: Visual Landmark Identification

The provided image, `travellers_part2.jpg` , showed a massive modern sports complex with several distinctive features.

Key Identifiers

- Large circular glass-and-steel arena
- Distinctive tiered roof structure
- Modern plaza and event complex design
- Multiple visible Belarusian national flags

The visible flags were especially important. Their red-and-green design with the white ornamental stripe identified them as the national flag of Belarus.

Another clue came from the suspect username:

`BelkaAndStrelka`

Belka and Strelka were famous Soviet space dogs, reinforcing the connection to a post-Soviet country such as Belarus.

Searching for:

`large circular arena Minsk Belarus`

quickly identified the location as:

Minsk-Arena (Минск-Арена)
Minsk, Belarus

Phase 2: Determining Photographer Position

After identifying Minsk-Arena, the next task was determining where the photographer was standing.

Step 1 — Analyze Perspective

The photographer appeared to be standing in the large pedestrian plaza facing the arena’s main entrance.

Step 2 — Establish Orientation

Based on map orientation and plaza layout, the photographer was facing roughly northeast toward Minsk-Arena.

Step 3 — Determine What Is Behind

Since the photographer faced the arena, their back was turned toward **Pobediteley Avenue** (Проспект Победителей).

Phase 3: Locating the Shopping Centre

Using Google Maps and satellite imagery, the area directly across Pobediteley Avenue from Minsk-Arena was examined.

Immediately southwest of the arena sits a large multi-story commercial complex.

This building serves as a major retail and entertainment hub for visitors attending events at Minsk-Arena.

The building was identified as:

ARENAcity (Arena City Mall)

The challenge title, “Shopping Centre”, further confirmed that the target building was a mall.

Phase 4: Verification

- **Geographic Match:** ARENAcity is located directly behind the photographer’s position.
- **Challenge Theme:** The title strongly hinted toward a retail complex.
- **Contextual Consistency:** The arena and shopping mall form a connected public entertainment area, making it a logical meetup location.
- **OSINT Logic:** The combination of flags, architecture, and urban layout uniquely identified the location.

Final Solution

The building directly behind the photographer at the Minsk-Arena plaza was determined to be:

SK-CERT{Arena_City}

Conclusion

This challenge demonstrated several important OSINT investigation techniques:

- Architectural landmark identification
- Geolocation through contextual clues
- National flag recognition
- Urban layout and orientation analysis
- Satellite imagery verification

By combining environmental analysis with geographic reasoning, the exact building behind the photographer was successfully identified.

